INSTITUTIONAL IT & SYSTEMS MANUAL

Basic Institutional IT Policy & Implementation Guide

Formulation and Implementation of Policy Governing IT Usage, Security, and Governance with Full Stakeholder Awareness

Policy Status: Approved & Implemented	**Target Audience:** All Staff & Students	**Effective Date:** Academic Year 2026-27
Department: IT & Systems	**Review Frequency:** Annual Review	**Statutory Scope:** Usage, Security, Governance

Core Purpose: To provide a clear, simple, and enforceable institutional IT policy that regulates IT usage, safeguards digital assets, ensures transparent governance, and ensures all faculty, administrative staff, and students are formally informed and compliant.

1. IT Usage Policy (Acceptable Use Policy - AUP)

Institutional computers, lab workstations, campus Wi-Fi, email, and portals are provided strictly to support education, coursework, and administrative duties.

- **Academic & Official Purpose:** IT infrastructure must be used for learning, teaching, research, and campus office work.
- **Individual Login Responsibility:** Every student and staff member receives a unique ID. Sharing usernames, passwords, or OTPs is strictly prohibited.
- **No Unauthorized Software:** Users must not download, install, or run unapproved software, games, or pirated media on institutional machines.
- **Prohibited Activities:** Accessing inappropriate/illegal content, cyber-bullying, spamming, torrent downloads, cryptocurrency mining, and attempting to bypass campus network filters.

2. IT Security Policy (Protection of Data & Systems)

To protect campus devices and user data from cyber threats, the following security standards are enforced across all departments:

Security Area	Key Policy Rule	Action Required by Users
Password Security	Minimum 8-12 characters combining letters, numbers, and symbols. Must be updated regularly.	Never write passwords down or share with peers; lock system when leaving desk.
Antivirus & Updates	All systems must run institutional antivirus/EDR and have OS updates enabled.	Do not disable antivirus shields or bypass scheduled system updates.
Network & Wi-Fi	Separation of Student Wi-Fi, Staff LAN, and Examination/Admin Networks.	Connect only to official campus SSID; do not setup rogue hotspots or VPN tunnels.
Data Protection & Backup	Important institutional files must be stored on approved institutional cloud/servers.	Avoid storing sensitive student or financial data on unencrypted personal USB drives.

3. IT Governance & Administration

Governance ensures clear ownership, lifecycle maintenance, and transparent decision-making for all institutional technology:

- **IT Steering Committee:** Headed by the Director/Principal with Deans and Head of IT. Responsible for setting priorities, budget approvals, and annual policy updates.
- **IT & Systems Department:** Responsible for day-to-day operations, lab upkeep, user account creation, network monitoring, security patching, and technical support.
- **Asset Management & Decommissioning:** Every computer, laptop, and network device is tagged in the asset register. Damaged or obsolete equipment is securely wiped and disposed of safely.

4. Implementation, Circulation & Stakeholder Awareness

To confirm that the approved policy is not just on paper but actively put into practice, the following four implementation pillars are executed:

Implementation Step	How It Is Implemented	Evidence / Output
1. Policy Circulation	The approved IT Policy is circulated via institutional email to all staff and students and hosted permanently on the intranet/portal.	Official email circular, student handbook section, website notice.
2. Student Awareness	Conducted during annual Student Induction/Orientation. Briefing on cyber safety, responsible internet use, and lab rules.	Orientation schedule, attendance log, student declaration forms.
3. Staff Awareness	Included in the new-employee joining kit and annual faculty/staff refresher workshops on phishing prevention and data handling.	HR joining checklist, IT clearance forms, workshop records.
4. Technical Enforcement	Firewall content filtering, mandatory digital undertaking prompt on first Wi-Fi/ERP login, and automatic account deactivation upon departure.	Firewall log reports, active user directories, deprovisioning logs.

5. Incident Reporting & Compliance

Any IT issue, lost device, password breach, or suspected virus infection must be reported immediately to the IT Helpdesk. Non-compliance results in graded actions:

- **First / Minor Breach:** Warning letter and temporary Wi-Fi access restriction until security refresher is completed.
- **Repeat / Serious Breach:** Formal suspension of IT privileges, referral to College Disciplinary Committee, and academic/disciplinary warning.
- **Malicious / Criminal Action:** Permanent debarment/termination and escalation under statutory cyber laws (IT Act).

6. Formal Approval & Implementation Sign-off

This basic IT policy has been reviewed, approved by institutional leadership, and circulated for immediate implementation:

Formulated By	Verified By	Approved & Issued By
Head - IT & Systems IT Infrastructure & Services	**Registrar / Dean** Institutional Administration	**Director / Principal** Governing Authority
Date: 28-Oct-2026	Date: 29-Oct-2026	Date: 30-Oct-2026